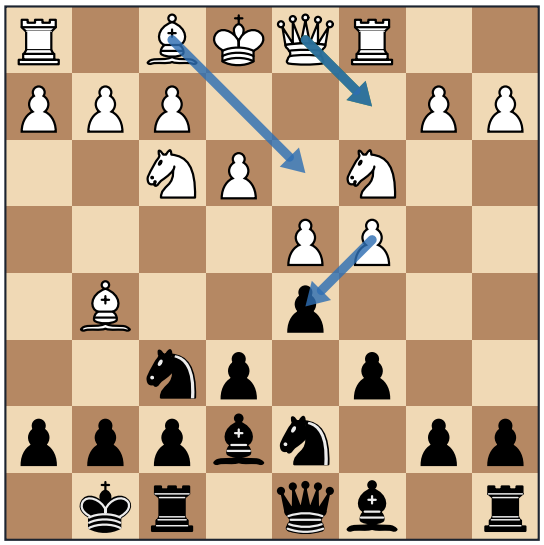
Queen's Gambit Declined

ECO D02-D69 | 211 named lines | Queen's Gambit / Slav family

In one sentence: The classical 1.d4 opening: White fights for e4 and the center; Black chooses solid structures (QGD, Slav) or active ones (QGA).

Memory pattern: c4 vs d5: White takes the center, Black holds with e6 or c6 and breaks with ...c5.



Main line: 1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e3 O-O 6.Nf3 Nbd7 7.Rc1 c6

Key ideas

1. Challenge d5 with c4: if Black takes (QGA), White regains the pawn and gets center.
2. QGD: Black holds d5 with ...e6; the light bishop is the problem piece.
3. Slav: ...c6 keeps the light bishop free for ...Bf5.
4. Exchange Carlsbad: White plays the minority attack b4-b5; Black counters with ...Ne4 and ...f5.
5. Black's freeing moves are ...c5 and ...e5; White's are e4 and Qc2/Bd3 kingside play.

Reading the diagram

Blue arrows = thematic plan moves for the side to move. Green arrow = engine's best move.
Engine at the end of the main line: **+0.24** (equal, depth 15). Best: Qc2.

The five coach questions

1. Ideal pawn structure?	c4/d4 against d5: Carlsbad (c6/e6), Slav chain (c6/d5), QGA (White regains c4), IQP or hanging pawns after exchanges. The minority attack (b4-b5) is White's key plan.
2. Where does my king go?	Both sides castle kingside; the king is rarely attacked early.
3. Best minor pieces?	White: Bg5/Bf4, Nc3/Nf3, Bd3, Rc1. Black: Nbd7, Bb7 or Bf5, Be7, Rc8.
4. Main middlegame plan?	White: minority attack, e4 break or Bd3-Qc2 kingside play. Black: ...c5/...e5 breaks and trading light bishops.
5. What does my opponent want?	White wants e4 or a queenside attack; Black wants a pawn break (...c5/...e5) and active bishops.

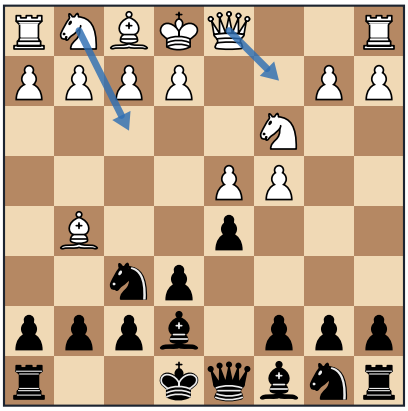
The main line, move by move

Most common continuation in the database: 1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e3 O-O 6.Nf3 Nbd7 7.Rc1 c6

Move	Why it is played
1. d4	Occupies the center with a pawn.
1... d5	Hold the center. Occupies the center with a pawn.
2. c4	Attack d5. Pawn move that supports the center or prepares a break.
2... e6	Pawn move that supports the center or prepares a break.
3. Nc3	Develops the knight to c3.
3... Nf6	Develops the knight to f6.
4. Bg5	Pin Nf6. Develops the bishop to g5.
4... Be7	Develops the bishop to e7.
5. e3	Support d4. Pawn move that supports the center or prepares a break.
5... O-O	Castles: the king reaches safety and the rook joins the center.
6. Nf3	Develops the knight to f3.
6... Nbd7	Develops the knight to d7.
7. Rc1	C-file pressure. Rook move: contests an open file or the center.
7... c6	Slav setup. Pawn move that supports the center or prepares a break.



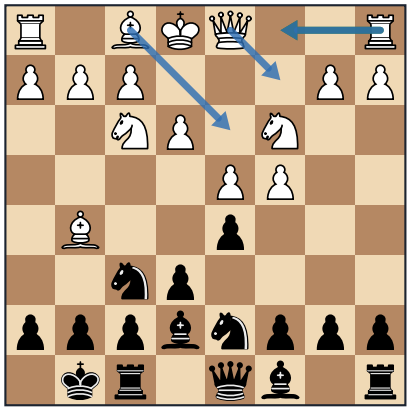
After 1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6



After e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Be7

Key variations

The most important named branches (ranked by how much theory lies beneath them). Diagram arrows: blue = plan moves, green = Stockfish.

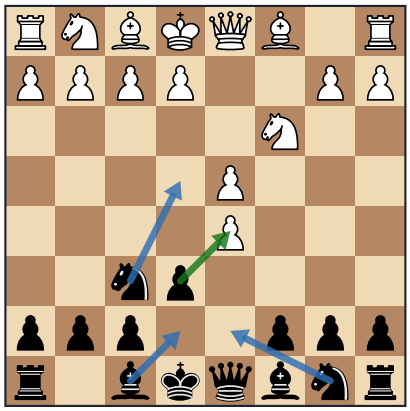


Position after the line

Orthodox Defense D60 | 39 lines

`1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 Be7 5.Bg5 O-O 6.e3 Nbd7`

Stockfish: **+0.27** (slightly better for White, depth 16). Best next move: Rc1.
What to look for: c4 (attack d5); Nc3 (develop); Nf3 (develop)
Sub-variations: Rubinstein Variation, Rubinstein Attack, Henneberger Variation, Main Line

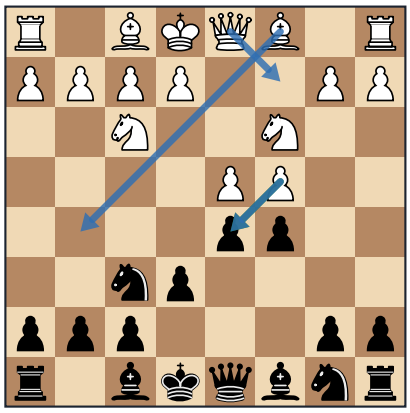


Position after the line

Exchange Variation D35 | 21 lines

`1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 d5 4.cxd5`

Stockfish: **+0.26** (slightly better for White, depth 17). Best next move: exd5.
What to look for: d5 (hold the center); e6 (solid); Nf6 (develop)
Sub-variations: Reshevsky Variation, Positional Variation, Carlsen Variation, Chameleon Variation

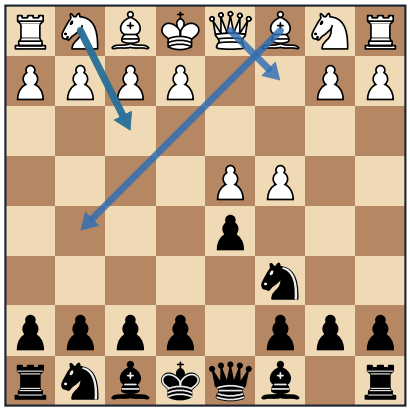


Position after the line

Semi-Tarrasch Defense D40 | 18 lines

`1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 c5`

Stockfish: **+0.37** (slightly better for White, depth 18). Best next move: cxd5.
What to look for: c4 (attack d5); Nc3 (develop); Nf3 (develop)
Sub-variations: Pillsbury Variation, Exchange Variation, Levenfish Variation, Symmetrical Variation

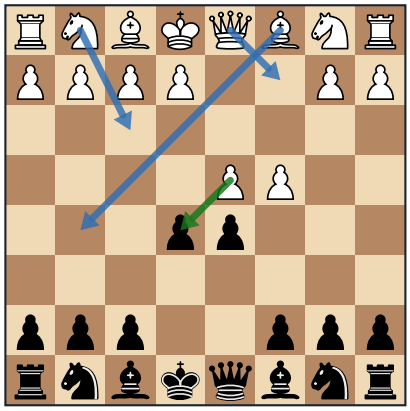


Position after the line

Chigorin Defense D07 | 13 lines

`1.d4 d5 2.c4 Nc6`

Stockfish: **+0.57** (slightly better for White, depth 16). Best next move: Nf3.
What to look for: c4 (attack d5); Nc3 (develop); Nf3 (develop)
Sub-variations: Exchange Variation, Main Line, Janowski Variation, Lazard Gambit

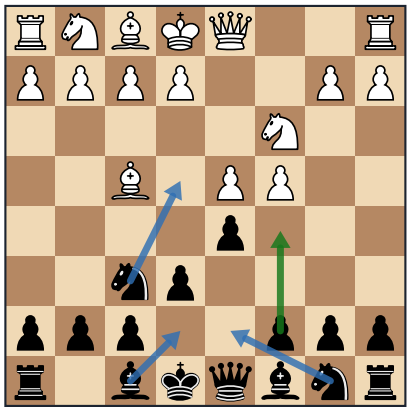


Position after the line

Albin Countergambit D08 | 13 lines

`1.d4 d5 2.c4 e5`

Stockfish: **+0.81** (clearly better for White, depth 16). Best next move: dxe5.
What to look for: c4 (attack d5); Nc3 (develop); Nf3 (develop)
Sub-variations: Fianchetto Variation, Balogh Variation, Janowski Variation, Krenosz Variation



Position after the line

Harrwitz Attack D35 | 9 lines

`1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bf4`

Stockfish: **+0.14** (equal, depth 16). Best next move: c5.
What to look for: d5 (hold the center); e6 (solid); Nf6 (develop)
Sub-variations: Two Knights Defense, Fianchetto Defense, Main Line, Orthodox Defense

Detailed repertoire notes

Queen's Gambit Declined (D30-D69, Black)

```
1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e3 O-O 6.Nf3 Nbd7 7.Rc1 c6 8.Bd3 dxc4 9.Bxc4 Nd5 10.Bxe7 Qxe7
11.O-O Nxc3 12.Rxc3 e5
```

Idea: Hold d5, keep a solid structure and free your position with ...c5 or ...e5.

Structure: Orthodox QGD: Black d5/e6 vs White c4/d4; the c8 bishop is initially passive but the structure is sturdy.

Pieces: Knights d7/f6, Be7, queen e7/c7, rook c8/d8. The light bishop develops to b7 or b4 later.

Plan: Play ...c5 or ...e5 when ready; trade a pair of minor pieces to relieve the cramp; aim for ...Ne4 ideas.

King: Castle early; free your light bishop with ...b6 or ...c5. **Opponent:** The minority attack or a c4-d4 squeeze; break with ...c5 or ...e5.

Watch out: Do not leave the bishop c8 locked forever; plan ...b6 and ...Bb7 or ...c5.

Expert and coach view

Capablanca and Karpov played the Queen's Gambit Declined with great success.

What a coach would tell you

Know the three structures: Carlsbad (minority attack), IQP (attack vs blockade) and hanging pawns. Study the plans for each, then choose the QGD, Slav or QGA based on your style.

Why play it

The classical 1.d4 opening: White fights for e4 and the center; Black chooses solid structures (QGD, Slav) or active ones (QGA).

Typical mistakes

• Taking on c4 without a plan to hold the pawn (...b5) or return it.

• Playing Bg5 too early or Nf3 too early without considering ...Ne4 or ...c5.

• Ignoring the minority attack and allowing a permanently weak c6 pawn.

Typical tactics and traps

• Elephant Trap: 1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Nbd7 5.cxd5 exd5 6.Nxd5? Nxd5! 7.Bxd8 Bb4+ and Black wins.

• Back-rank tactics when queens trade and the rooks are unconnected.

Endgame and middlegame outlook

QGD endings are usually balanced; Black's solid structure makes winning chances hard for White.

Study checklist

[ ] Play the main line on a board and say each move's purpose aloud.

[ ] Learn the five coach questions by heart; answer them without notes.

[ ] Drill two sub-variations until the moves feel automatic.

[ ] Play three games with the opening, then review where you left theory.

[ ] Re-read the traps page the day before a tournament.

The opening tree

Every named line in this family as a tree. Gray moves are inherited from the parent; green after the arrow are the new moves that define the variation. Large green dots mark branches with 10 or more lines.

- **Queen's Gambit Declined (all lines)** — D30
  `1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6`
  - **Albin Countergambit** — D08
    `1.d4 d5 2.c4 e5`
    - **Normal Line** — D08
      `1.d4 d5 2.c4 e5 -> 3.dxe5 d4 4.Nf3`
    - **Spassky Variation** — D08
      `1.d4 d5 2.c4 e5 -> 3.dxe5 d4 4.e4`
    - **Tartakower Defense** — D08
      `1.d4 d5 2.c4 e5 -> 3.dxe5 d4 4.Nf3 c5`
    - **Fianchetto Variation** — D09
      `1.d4 d5 2.c4 e5 -> 3.dxe5 d4 4.Nf3 Nc6 5.g3`
      - **Be6 Line** — D09
        `1.d4 d5 2.c4 e5 3.dxe5 d4 4.Nf3 Nc6 5.g3 -> 5...Be6`
      - **Bf5 Line** — D09
        `1.d4 d5 2.c4 e5 3.dxe5 d4 4.Nf3 Nc6 5.g3 -> 5...Bf5`
      - **Bg4 Line** — D09
        `1.d4 d5 2.c4 e5 3.dxe5 d4 4.Nf3 Nc6 5.g3 -> 5...Bg4`
    - **Modern Line** — D08
      `1.d4 d5 2.c4 e5 -> 3.dxe5 d4 4.Nf3 Nc6 5.Nbd2`
    - **Balogh Variation** — D08
      `1.d4 d5 2.c4 e5 -> 3.dxe5 d4 4.Nf3 Nc6 5.Nbd2 Qe7`
    - **Janowski Variation** — D08
      `1.d4 d5 2.c4 e5 -> 3.dxe5 d4 4.Nf3 Nc6 5.Nbd2 f6`
    - **Lasker Trap** — D08
      `1.d4 d5 2.c4 e5 -> 3.dxe5 d4 4.e3 Bb4 5.Bd2 dxe3`
    - **Krenosz Variation** — D08
      `1.d4 d5 2.c4 e5 -> 3.dxe5 d4 4.Nf3 Nc6 5.Nbd2 Bg4 6.h3 Bxf3 7.Nxf3 Bb4 8.Bd2 Qe7`
  - **Austrian Defense** — D06
    `1.d4 d5 2.c4 c5`
    - **Gusev Countergambit** — D06
      `1.d4 d5 2.c4 c5 -> 3.cxd5 Nf6`
    - **Haberditz Variation** — D06
      `1.d4 d5 2.c4 c5 -> 3.cxd5 Nf6 4.e4 Nxe4 5.dxc5 Qa5`
  - **Baltic Defense** — D06
    `1.d4 d5 2.c4 Bf5`
    - **Queen Attack** — D06
      `1.d4 d5 2.c4 Bf5 -> 3.Qb3`
    - **Queen Attack Deferred** — D06
      `1.d4 d5 2.c4 Bf5 -> 3.Nc3 e6 4.Qb3`
    - **Pseudo-Chigorin** — D06
      `1.d4 d5 2.c4 Bf5 -> 3.Nc3 e6 4.Nf3 Nc6`
    - **Pseudo-Slav** — D02
      `1.d4 d5 2.Nf3 Bf5 3.c4 e6 4.Nc3 c6`
    - **Argentinian Gambit** — D06
      `1.d4 d5 2.c4 Bf5 -> 3.cxd5 Bxb1 4.Qa4 c6 5.dxc6 Nxc6`
  - **Chigorin Defense** — D07
    `1.d4 d5 2.c4 Nc6`
    - **Exchange Variation** — D07
      `1.d4 d5 2.c4 Nc6 -> 3.cxd5 Qxd5`
      - **Costa's Line** — D07
        `1.d4 d5 2.c4 Nc6 3.cxd5 Qxd5 -> 4.e3 e5 5.Nc3 Bb4 6.Bd2 Bxc3 7.Bxc3 exd4 8.Ne2`
    - **Lazard Gambit** — D07
      `1.d4 d5 2.c4 Nc6 -> 3.Nf3 e5`
    - **Main Line** — D07
      `1.d4 d5 2.c4 Nc6 -> 3.Nf3 Bg4`
      - **Alekhine Variation** — D07
        `1.d4 d5 2.c4 Nc6 3.Nf3 Bg4 -> 4.Qa4`

- **Tartakower Gambit** D07
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 Nc6 -> 3.Nc3 e5
- **Janowski Variation** D07
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 Nc6 -> 3.Nc3 dxc4 4.Nf3
- **Modern Gambit** D07
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 Nc6 -> 3.Nc3 dxc4 4.Nf3 Nf6
- **Marshall Defense** D06
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 Nf6
  - **Tan Gambit** D06
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 Nf6 -> 3.cxd5 c6
- **Semi-Slav** D31
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6
  - **Abrahams Variation** D31
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 -> 3.Nc3 c6 4.Nf3 dxc4 5.a4 Bb4 6.e3 b5 7.Bd2 a5
  - **Junge Variation** D31
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 -> 3.Nf3 c6 4.Nc3 dxc4 5.a4 Bb4 6.e3 b5 7.Bd2 Qb6
  - **Koomen Variation** D31
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 -> 3.Nc3 c6 4.Nf3 dxc4 5.e3 b5 6.a4 Bb4 7.Bd2 Qe7
- **Zilbermints Gambit** D06
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 b5
- **Queen's Knight Variation** D31
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 -> 3.Nc3
- **Alapin Variation** D31
  1.d4 e6 2.c4 b6 3.Nc3 d5
- **Austrian Attack** D06
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 c5 3.dxc5 d4
  - **Salvio Countergambit** D06
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 c5 3.dxc5 d4
- **Charousek Variation** D31
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 -> 3.Nc3 Be7
  - **Miladinovic Gambit** D31
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Be7 -> 4.e4 dxe4 5.f3
- **Janowski Variation** D31
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 -> 3.Nc3 a6
- **Normal Defense** D35
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 -> 3.Nc3 Nf6
- **Exchange Variation** D35
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 d5 4.cxd5
  - **Positional Variation** D35
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 d5 4.cxd5 -> 4...exd5 5.Bg5
  - **Reshevsky Variation** D36
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 d5 4.cxd5 -> 4...exd5 5.Bg5 c6 6.Qc2
  - **Sämisch Variation** D35
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 Nbd7 5.cxd5 exd5 6.Bf4
  - **Carlsen Variation** D35
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 d5 4.cxd5 -> 4...exd5 5.Bg5 Be7 6.e3 h6 7.Bh4 Bg4
  - **Chameleon Variation** D35
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 d5 4.cxd5 -> 4...exd5 5.Bg5 Be7 6.e3 O-O 7.Bd3 Nbd7 8.Qc2 Re8 9.Nge2 Nf8 10.O-O-O
- **Harrwitz Attack** D35
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 -> 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bf4
  - **Fianchetto Defense** D37
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Be7 4.Nf3 Nf6 5.Bf4 O-O 6.e3 b6
  - **Orthodox Defense** D37
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Nf3 Be7 5.Bf4 O-O 6.e3 c6
  - **Two Knights Defense** D37
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 Be7 5.Bf4 O-O 6.e3 Nbd7
    - **Blockade Line** D37
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 d5 4.Nf3 Be7 5.Bf4 O-O 6.e3 Nbd7 7.c5

- **Main Line** D37
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 Be7 5.Bf4 O-O 6.e3 c5 7.dxc5 Bxc5
- **Modern Variation** D50
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 -> 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5
  - **Knight Defense** D51
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 -> 4...Nbd7
  - **Heral Variation** D53
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 -> 4...Be7 5.Bxf6
  - **Normal Line** D55
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 Be7 5.Bg5 O-O 6.e3
- **Three Knights Variation** D37
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3
- **Traditional Variation** D30
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Bg5
- **Barmen Variation** D37
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 Nbd7
- **Been-Koomen Variation** D50
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 -> 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 c5
- **Capablanca Variation** D30
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Bg5 h6
  - **Anti-Cambridge Springs Variation** D51
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Nbd7 5.e3 c6 6.a3
- **Ragozin Defense** D38
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 Bb4
  - **Alekhine Variation** D38
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 Bb4 -> 5.Qa4
  - **Vienna Variation** D39
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 Bb4 -> 5.Bg5 dxc4
- **Semi-Tarrasch Defense** D40
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 c5
  - **Pillsbury Variation** D40
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Nf3 c5 5.Bg5
  - **Exchange Variation** D41
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 c5 -> 5.cxd5 Nxd5 6.e4
  - **with e3** D40
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 c5 3.Nf3 Nf6 4.Nc3 e6 5.e3 Nc6 6.Bd3
  - **Main Line** D42
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 c5 -> 5.cxd5 Nxd5 6.e3 Nc6 7.Bd3
  - **Symmetrical Variation** D40
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Nf3 c5 5.e3 Nc6 6.Bd3 Bd6 7.O-O O-O
  - **Endgame Variation** D41
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 c5 -> 5.cxd5 cxd4 6.Qxd4 exd5 7.e4 dxe4 8.Qxd8
  - **Krause Variation** D50
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 c5 5.Nf3 cxd4 6.Nxd4 e5 7.Ndb5 a6 8.Qa4
  - **San Sebastian Variation** D41
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.cxd5 Nxd5 5.e4 Nxc3 6.bxc3 c5 7.Nf3 cxd4 8.cxd4 Bb4 9.Bd2 Qa5
  - **Levenfish Variation** D40
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Nf3 c5 5.e3 Nc6 6.Bd3 Bd6 7.O-O O-O 8.Qe2 Qe7 9.dxc5 Bxc5 10.e4
  - **Kmoch Variation** D41
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Nf3 c5 5.cxd5 Nxd5 6.e4 Nxc3 7.bxc3 cxd4 8.cxd4 Bb4 9.Bd2 Bxd2 10.Qxd2 O-O 11.Bb5
- **Tarrasch Defense** D32
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 -> 3.Nc3 c5 4.cxd5 exd5
  - **Pseudo-Tarrasch** D30
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 c5
  - **Pseudo-Tarrasch Bishop Attack** D30
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 c5 4.cxd5 exd5 5.Bg5
  - **Stoltz Variation** D34
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 c5 4.cxd5 exd5 5.g3 Nc6 6.Bg2 Nf6 7.O-O Be7 8.Nc3 O-O 9.Bg5 Be6 10.Rc1 b6

- **Three Knights** D37
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 dxc4
  - **Vienna Variation** D37
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 dxc4
- **Vienna Variation** D30
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Bg5 Bb4
  - **Quiet Variation** D37
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 dxc4 5.e3
- **Pseudo-Tarrasch Variation** D50
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 -> 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 c5 5.cxd5
  - **Canal Variation** D50
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 c5 5.cxd5 -> 5...Qb6
  - **Primitive Pillsbury Variation** D50
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 c5 5.Nf3 cxd4 6.Qxd4
- **Lasker Defense** D53
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 d5 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e3 Ne4
  - **Teichmann Variation** D56
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 Be7 5.Bg5 h6 6.Bh4 O-O 7.e3 Ne4 8.Bxe7 Qxe7 9.Qc2
  - **Main Line** D57
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Be7 4.Nf3 Nf6 5.Bg5 h6 6.Bh4 O-O 7.e3 Ne4 8.Bxe7 Qxe7 9.cxd5 Nxc3 10.bxc3
  - **Bernstein Variation** D57
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 d5 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e3 h6 6.Bh4 O-O 7.Nf3 Ne4 8.Bxe7 Qxe7 9.cxd5 Nxc3 10.bxc3 exd5 11.Qb3 Qd6
    - **Mar del Plata Gambit** D57
      1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e3 O-O 6.Nf3 h6 7.Bh4 Ne4 8.Bxe7 Qxe7 9.cxd5 Nxc3 10.bxc3 exd5 11.Q…
  - **Russian Variation** D56
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e3 O-O 6.Nf3 h6 7.Bh4 Ne4 8.Bxe7 Qxe7 9.Qc2 Nf6 10.Bd3 dxc4 11.Bxc4 c5 …
- **Manhattan Variation** D51
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 -> 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Nbd7 5.e3 Bb4
- **Spielmann Variation** D30
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 -> 3.Nf3 Nf6 4.e3 c6 5.Nbd2 g6
- **Alekhine Variation** D51
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 -> 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Nbd7 5.Nf3 c6 6.e4
- **Miles Variation** D37
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 Be7 5.Bg5 O-O 6.Qc2
- **Neo-Orthodox Variation** D54
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 d5 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e3 O-O 6.Rc1
  - **Main Line** D55
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 Be7 5.Bg5 h6 6.Bh4 O-O 7.e3
- **Cambridge Springs Defense** D52
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 c6 3.Nf3 Nf6 4.Nc3 e6 5.Bg5 Nbd7 6.e3 Qa5
  - **Capablanca Variation** D52
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Nbd7 5.e3 c6 6.Nf3 Qa5 7.Bxf6
  - **Rubinstein Variation** D52
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 c6 3.Nf3 Nf6 4.Nc3 e6 5.Bg5 Nbd7 6.e3 Qa5 -> 7.Nd2 dxc4
  - **Yugoslav Variation** D52
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 c6 3.Nf3 Nf6 4.Nc3 e6 5.Bg5 Nbd7 6.e3 Qa5 -> 7.cxd5 Nxd5
  - **Bogoljubow Variation** D52
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 c6 3.Nf3 Nf6 4.Nc3 e6 5.Bg5 Nbd7 6.e3 Qa5 -> 7.Nd2 Bb4 8.Qc2
  - **Argentine Variation** D52
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Nbd7 5.e3 c6 6.Nf3 Qa5 7.Nd2 Bb4 8.Qc2 O-O 9.Bh4
- **Knight Defense** D37
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 Nbd7 5.Bg5 h6 6.Bh4 dxc4
  - **Alekhine Gambit** D37
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 Nbd7 5.Bg5 h6 6.Bh4 dxc4
- **Orthodox Defense** D60
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 Be7 5.Bg5 O-O 6.e3 Nbd7
  - **Botvinnik Variation** D60
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 Be7 5.Bg5 O-O 6.e3 Nbd7 -> 7.Bd3

- **Main Line** D63
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 Be7 5.Bg5 O-O 6.e3 Nbd7 -> 7.Rc1
- **Rauzer Variation** D60
  1.d4 d5 2.Nf3 Nf6 3.c4 e6 4.Nc3 Be7 5.Bg5 O-O 6.e3 Nbd7 7.Qb3
- **Rubinstein Variation** D61
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e3 O-O 6.Nf3 Nbd7 7.Qc2
  - **Flohr Line** D62
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 Be7 5.Bg5 O-O 6.e3 Nbd7 7.Qc2 c5 8.cxd5
- **Henneberger Variation** D63
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 Be7 5.Bg5 O-O 6.e3 Nbd7 -> 7.Rc1 a6
- **Bd3 Line** D66
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e3 O-O 6.Nf3 Nbd7 7.Rc1 c6 8.Bd3
- **Rubinstein Attack** D64
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 Be7 5.Bg5 O-O 6.e3 Nbd7 -> 7.Rc1 c6 8.Qc2
- **Swiss** D63
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 Be7 5.Bg5 O-O 6.e3 Nbd7 -> 7.Rc1 a6 8.cxd5
  - **Carlsbad Variation** D63
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 Be7 5.Bg5 O-O 6.e3 Nbd7 7.Rc1 a6 8.cxd5
- **Capablanca Variation** D63
  1.Nf3 d5 2.d4 Nf6 3.c4 e6 4.Nc3 Be7 5.Bg5 O-O 6.e3 Nbd7 7.Rc1 b6 8.cxd5 exd5 9.Bb5
- **Pillsbury Variation** D63
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 d5 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e3 O-O 6.Nf3 Nbd7 7.Rc1 b6 8.cxd5 exd5 9.Bd3
- **Capablanca System** D67
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e3 O-O 6.Nf3 Nbd7 7.Rc1 c6 8.Bd3 dxc4 9.Bxc4 Nd5
- **Fianchetto Variation** D66
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 c6 5.Nf3 Be7 6.e3 Nbd7 7.Rc1 O-O 8.Bd3 dxc4 9.Bxc4 b5
- **Janowski Variation** D67
  1.d4 d5 2.Nf3 Nf6 3.c4 e6 4.Nc3 Be7 5.Bg5 O-O 6.e3 Nbd7 7.Rc1 c6 8.Bd3 dxc4 9.Bxc4 Nd5 10.h4
- **Alekhine Variation** D67
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e3 O-O 6.Nf3 Nbd7 7.Rc1 c6 8.Bd3 dxc4 9.Bxc4 Nd5 10.Bxe7 Qxe7 11.Ne4
- **Classical Variation** D68
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e3 O-O 6.Nf3 Nbd7 7.Rc1 c6 8.Bd3 dxc4 9.Bxc4 Nd5 10.Bxe7 Qxe7 11.O-O Nx…
- **Semmering Variation** D30
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 c6 3.Nf3 Nf6 4.e3 e6 5.Nbd2 Nbd7 6.Bd3 c5
- **Stonewall Variation** D30
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 c6 3.Nf3 Nf6 4.e3 e6 5.Nbd2 Ne4 6.Bd3 f5
- **Westphalian Variation** D38
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 Bb4 5.Bg5 Nbd7 6.e3 c5
- **Anti-Tartakower Variation** D55
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 Be7 5.Bg5 O-O 6.e3 h6 7.Bxf6
  - **Petrosian Variation** D55
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 Be7 5.Bg5 h6 6.Bxf6 Bxf6 7.e3 O-O 8.Rc1 c6 9.Bd3 Nd7 10.O-O dxc4 11.Bxc4
- **Rochlin Variation** D51
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 -> 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Nbd7 5.Nf3 c6 6.Rc1 Qa5 7.Bd2
- **Tartakower Defense** D58
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.Nc3 Be7 5.Bg5 h6 6.Bh4 O-O 7.e3 b6
  - **Exchange Variation** D58
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Be7 4.Nf3 Nf6 5.Bg5 h6 6.Bh4 O-O 7.e3 b6 8.cxd5 exd5
  - **Makogonov Exchange Variation** D59
    1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Be7 4.Nf3 Nf6 5.Bg5 h6 6.Bh4 O-O 7.e3 b6 8.cxd5 Nxd5
- **Uhlmann Variation** D53
  1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 -> 3.Nc3 Be7 4.Nf3 Nf6 5.Bg5 h6 6.Bh4 O-O 7.Rc1 dxc4
- **Pillsbury Attack** D55
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 b6 4.Nc3 d5 5.cxd5 exd5 6.Bg5 Be7 7.e3 O-O 8.Bd3 Bb7 9.Ne5

One-page memory sheet

Move-order pattern

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1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e3 O-O
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Plan chain

White	c4 -> Nc3 -> Nf3 -> Bg5 -> e3
Black	d5 -> e6 -> Nf6 -> Be7 -> O-O

Three rules to remember

1. c4 vs d5: White takes the center, Black holds with e6 or c6 and breaks with ...c5.

2. White: minority attack, e4 break or Bd3-Qc2 kingside play. Black: ...c5/...e5 breaks and trading light bishops.

3. White wants e4 or a queenside attack; Black wants a pawn break (...c5/...e5) and active bishops.

Pawn structure in one line

c4/d4 against d5: Carlsbad (c6/e6), Slav chain (c6/d5), QGA (White regains c4), IQP or hanging pawns after exchanges. The minority attack (b4-b5) is White's key plan.